

PROBLEM

Qatar ranks **73rd** in EF English Proficiency Index; below UAE, Lebanon, Turkey, Nepal, South Korea, Russia.

94% of people believe critical thinking is important, and **86%** believe it is lacking in public

75% of long-term job success depends on people skills, while only **25%** on technical knowledge

How might we improve English proficiency, communication skills, and thinking ability of the most "vulnerable" public school students?

EXISTING SOLUTIONS

Continuously evolving school curriculum

High student teacher ratio means less time for focused work

Class time isn't enough for sufficient exposure

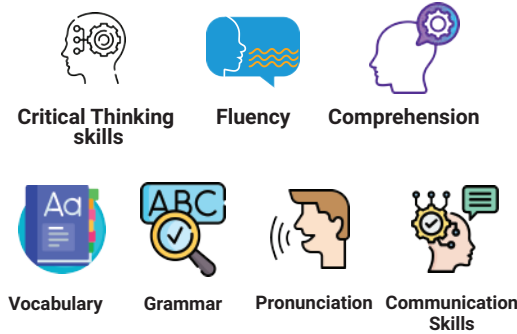
Extra-Curricular Activities (Debate Club/MUN)

Subject to self selection bias, shy/most vulnerable students are unlikely to volunteer

Competitive elements creates an incentive for schools to recruit those who are already "the best"

BUT WHY DEBATE?

Studies on EFL students show students undergoing debate education show much higher improvement across multiple fields compared to control groups



COLLABORATORS AND BENEFICIARIES

Stakeholder:

وزارة التربية والتعليم والتعليم العالي
Ministry of Education and Higher Education
دولة قطر State of Qatar

Collaborators:

كلية السياسات العامة
College of Public Policy
جامعة حمد بن خليفة
HAMAD BIN KHALIFA UNIVERSITY
مناظرات قطر
qatar debate
عضو في مؤسسة قطر
Member of Qatar Foundation

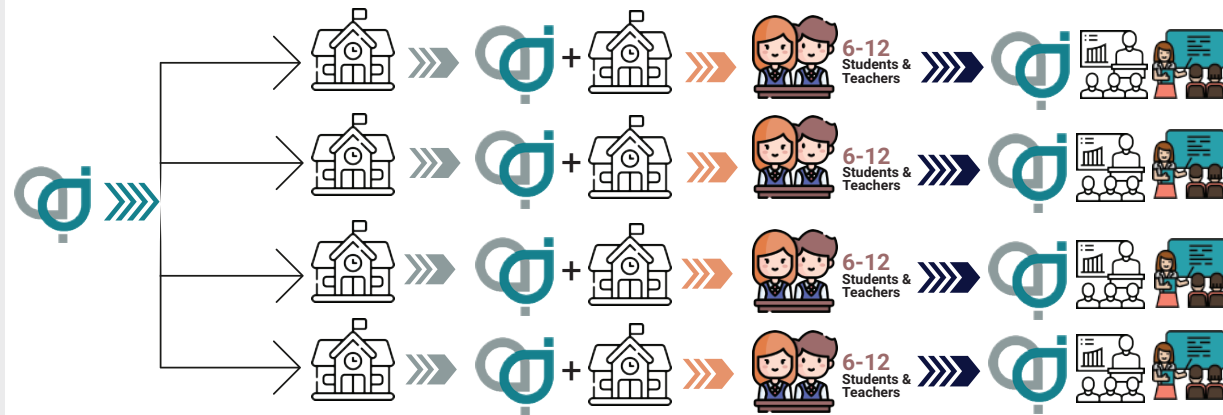
Beneficiaries:

Vulnerable students in preparatory and secondary public schools in Qatar

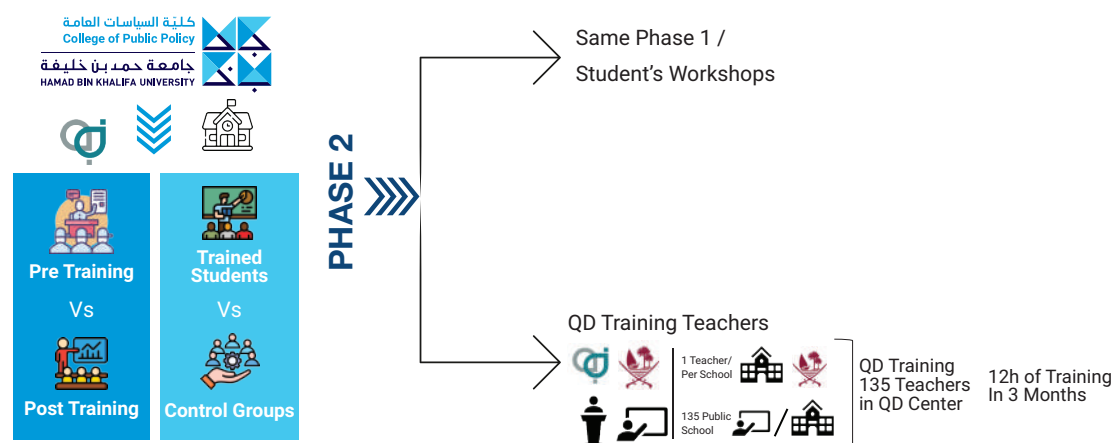
Early Adopters:

Jassim bin Hamad SSB
Ibn Khaldoun PSB
Amna bint Wahhab SSG
Qatar PSG

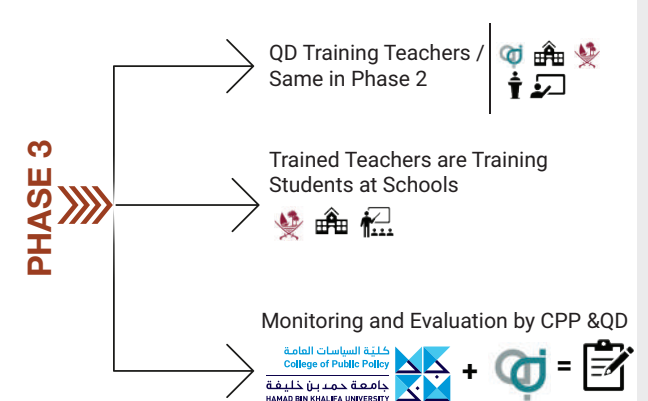
PHASE 1



PHASE 2



PHASE 3



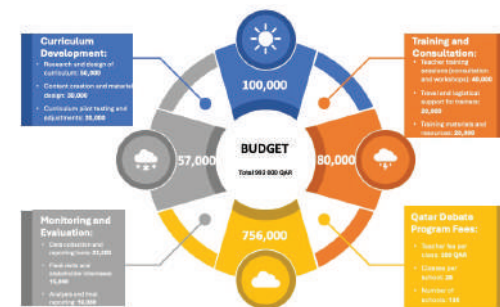
INPUTS

- 2 Trainers from QatarDebate
- Developed Curriculum from QatarDebate
- 2 Evaluators from College of Public Policy, HBKU
- Focal Point from each school
- 2 Independent Debate Adjudicators to evaluate student's progress

OUTPUT & IMPLEMENTATION

- QatarDebate and MOEHE to contact 4 chosen schools and establish focal point
- Validate criteria for schools to select 6-12 "vulnerable" students for class
- Schools select students with permission from parents
- Schools select another batch of 6-12 students as control group
- QatarDebate creates debate curriculum
- QatarDebate Trainers conduct once a week after school trainings with continuous feedback from focal points
- After 6 months, QatarDebate conducts teacher training for 135 public schools' teachers
- Starting Year 2, schools conduct their own debate training with monitoring assistance from QatarDebate
- Continuous monitoring and evaluation, pre and post

EST. ANNUAL BUDGET



SCAN QR CODES



OUTCOMES

Short-Term Outcomes



Increased English proficiency compared to control group

5/15

Emerging ability across at least 5/15 metric

Medium-Term Outcomes

130

public schools have at least 1 QatarDebate certified Debate Trainer



Students demonstrate developing ability across at least 10/15 metrics

Long-Term Outcomes



All schools have at least 2 certified teachers



Students with special need for English proficiency and presentation receive adequate support across Qatar's public education system